

3 Simple Workflows Every VA Can Build

No coding, no theory, just trigger → action. Each example below is something you can build, test, and publish in a single GHL sub-account in under 15 minutes. Bookmark this page; you'll come back to it.

1. New Lead Welcome

2. Appointment Reminder

3. Missed-Call Text-Back

EXAMPLE 1 OF 3

New Lead Welcome

The moment a new lead comes in, they get a text and an email instead of waiting hours for a human to notice them. This is the single most common workflow in GHL, and the first one most VAs ever build.

THE FLOW

TRIGGER

Tag "new-lead" added to a contact

+

ACTION

Send a welcome SMS

+

WAIT

Wait 5 minutes

+

ACTION

HOW TO BUILD IT

1 Go to Automation → Workflows → Create Workflow

Choose "Start from Scratch" so you can see every piece being added.

2 Click "Add New Trigger"

Search for and select *Tag Added*. In the trigger's settings, choose the tag *new-lead* (or whichever tag this client uses to mark a fresh lead).

3 Click the + below the trigger, add "Send SMS"

Write a short, friendly message confirming you received their info. Use a merge field like `{{contact.first_name}}` so it feels personal.

4 Click + again, add "Wait"

Set it to wait 5 minutes. This small gap is what keeps the sequence from feeling like a robot fired two messages at once.

5 Click + again, add "Send Email"

Write a slightly longer welcome message, what to expect next, and a way to book a call if relevant.

6 Test, then publish

Add the *new-lead* tag to your own test contact and confirm both messages arrive correctly before turning the workflow on for real leads.



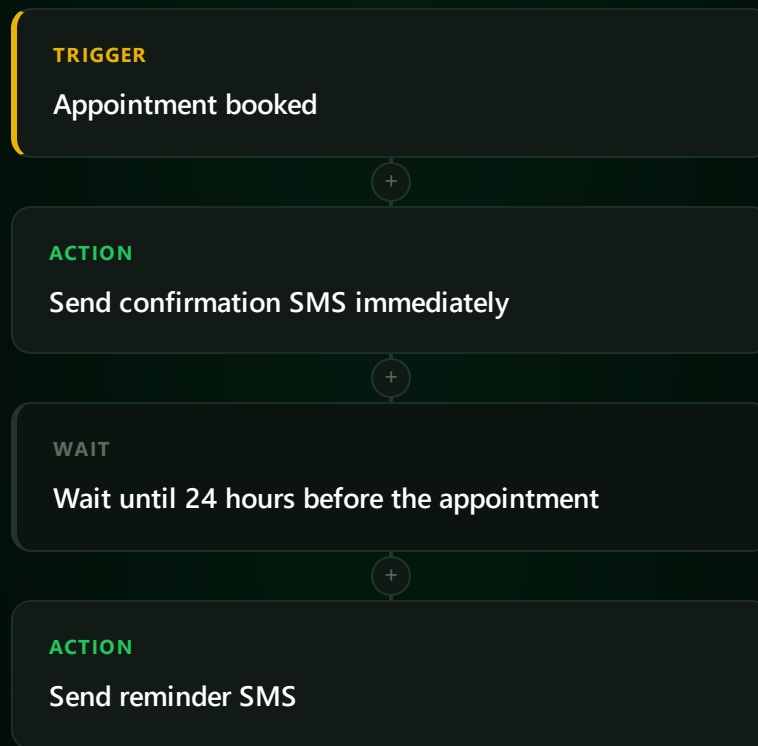
Why it matters: responding to a new lead in minutes instead of hours is one of the biggest levers in sales. This workflow does it automatically, 24/7, with zero ongoing effort from you once it's live.

EXAMPLE 2 OF 3

Appointment Reminder

Every booked appointment gets a confirmation right away and a reminder the day before, so the client shows up. This is the easiest way to cut no-shows for almost any service business.

THE FLOW



HOW TO BUILD IT

1

Create a new workflow

Same starting point: Automation → Workflows → Create Workflow → Start from Scratch.

2

Add the trigger "Appointment Status"

Set the condition to fire when status changes to *Booked* or *Confirmed*, depending on the calendar setup.

3

Add "Send SMS" for the instant confirmation

Confirm the date, time, and location or link, using the `{{appointment.time}}` merge field so it's always correct.

4

Add a "Wait" step set to "Until a specific time before/after an event"

Configure it to wait until 24 hours before the appointment date and time. This is different from a simple "wait 24 hours," it always lands relative to the actual appointment.

5

Add a second "Send SMS" for the reminder

Keep it short: "Reminder: your appointment is tomorrow at `{{appointment.time}}`. Reply C to confirm."

6

Test on a real (or fake) booking, then publish

Book a test appointment for a few minutes out, shrink the wait step temporarily to confirm timing logic, then set it back and publish.



Why it matters: automated reminders are consistently one of the biggest levers for cutting no-shows for service businesses, often by a wide margin, and they require zero manual follow-up once built.

EXAMPLE 3 OF 3

Missed-Call Text-Back

The simplest workflow on this page: one trigger, one action. If a call goes unanswered, the caller gets an instant text instead of just a dial tone.

THE FLOW

TRIGGER

Inbound call goes unanswered

+

ACTION

Send "sorry we missed you" SMS with a booking link

HOW TO BUILD IT

1

Create a new workflow

Automation → Workflows → Create Workflow → Start from Scratch.

2

Add the trigger "Customer Missed Call"

This trigger type fires specifically when an inbound call to the business number isn't answered.

3

Add "Send SMS"

Write something like: "Sorry we missed your call! How can we help? Book a time here: [link]." Keep it short and immediate. The caller is texting from the moment they hang up.

4

Test by calling the business number and not picking up

Confirm the text arrives within a few seconds, then publish.



Why it matters: a missed call is one of the easiest leads to lose. Most callers won't leave a voicemail or call back; they'll just call the next business on the list. This workflow catches them before they do.

BEFORE YOU PUBLISH, ANY WORKFLOW

- ☐ **Enrolled a test contact** and watched the workflow run start to finish.
- ☐ **Read every message** out loud, checking tone, spelling, and merge fields (no "Hi {{contact.first_name}}" showing up literally).
- ☐ **Confirmed the trigger** is scoped correctly (right tag, right calendar, right pipeline), not accidentally firing for every contact.
- ☐ **Checked the timing** of any Wait steps, especially time-of-day sends, so messages don't land at 3am.
- ☐ **Turned the workflow ON** (built workflows are paused by default until you toggle them live).

⚠ THE #1 MISTAKE

Publishing a workflow without testing it on a fake contact first. A broken automation doesn't fail quietly. It can text the wrong message to every real contact who matches the trigger, repeatedly. **Always test on yourself before you go live.**